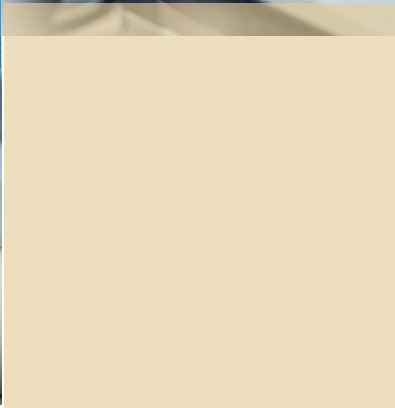
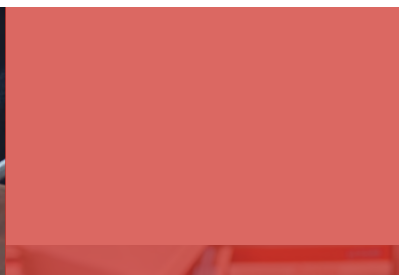


Developing a Competitive SAMHSA Grant Application

March 2025



SAMHSA

Substance Abuse and Mental Health
Services Administration

Developing a Competitive SAMHSA Grant Application was prepared for the Substance Abuse and Mental Health Services Administration (SAMHSA) under contract number HHSS283201700049I/75S20322F42005 with SAMHSA, U.S. Department of Health and Human Services (HHS). Philip Passarelli served as contracting officer's representative.

Originating Office

Office of Financial Resources. Substance Abuse and Mental Health Services Administration, 5600 Fishers Lane, Rockville, MD 20857. Released 2025.

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Released 2025

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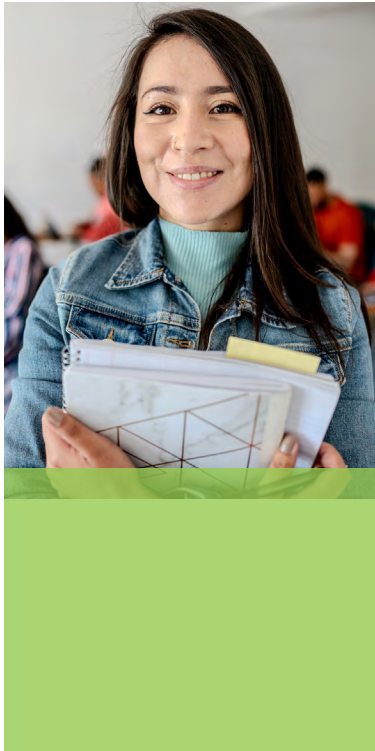
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Introduction

The Substance Abuse and Mental Health Services Administration (SAMHSA), an agency of the U.S. Department of Health and Human Services (HHS), was established by an act of Congress in 1992 under Public Law 102-321. SAMHSA was established to direct attention, resources, and programs toward improving the lives of individuals living with or at risk for mental health and substance use disorders. SAMHSA's discretionary grant programs support many activities that develop and deliver substance use/misuse prevention, substance use disorder treatment, and mental health services.

Purpose of this Manual

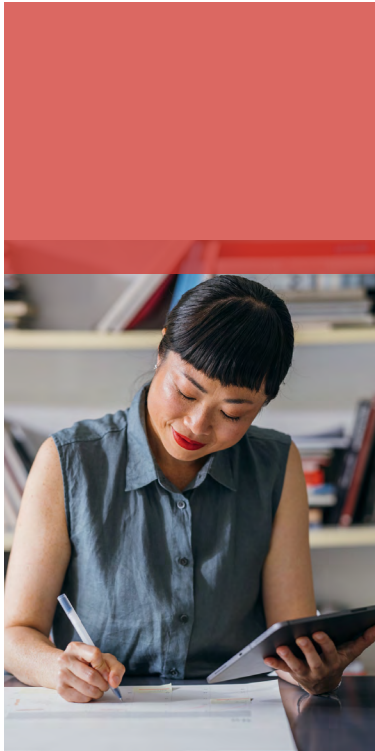
The *Developing a Competitive SAMHSA Grant Application* manual is designed to provide applicants with information on how to prepare competitive, well-developed SAMHSA grant applications.

Objectives

This manual will provide you with information on how to:

- Prepare your organization to quickly and efficiently respond to a grant announcement
- Review SAMHSA funding opportunities to determine whether you meet the eligibility criteria for a particular announcement
- Decide if you can realistically implement a project
- Assemble data to justify the need for funding
- Identify your resources and individuals to participate on the writing team
- Write an application that effectively responds to the evaluation criteria

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Chapter 1: SAMHSA's Mission, Priorities, and Grant Programs

Overview

This chapter provides an overview of SAMHSA's mission, priorities, and grant programs. It also identifies the SAMHSA centers and offices that offer funding opportunities.

SAMHSA's Mission and Priorities

SAMHSA is the agency within HHS that leads public health efforts to advance the behavioral health of the nation and improve the lives of individuals living with mental and substance use disorders and their families. Its mission is to lead public health and service delivery efforts that promote mental health, prevent substance misuse, and provide treatments and supports to foster recovery while ensuring access and better outcomes for all. More information on SAMHSA is available at [SAMHSA.gov](https://www.samhsa.gov).

To achieve its mission, SAMHSA has identified five priority areas to better meet the behavioral health needs of individuals, communities, and service providers.

- Preventing substance use and overdose
- Enhancing access to suicide prevention and mental health services
- Promoting resilience and emotional health for children, youth, and families
- Integrating behavioral and physical healthcare
- Strengthening the behavioral health workforce



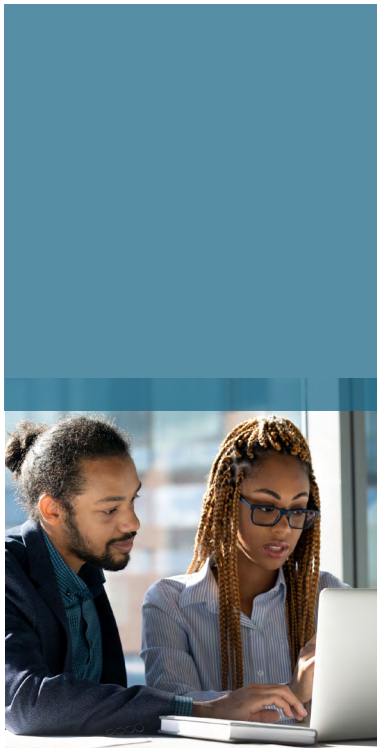
SAMHSA's Grant Programs

SAMHSA's grant programs focus on improving the quality and availability of substance use/misuse prevention, substance use disorder treatment, and mental health services nationwide. These programs involve the implementation of evidence-based approaches to prevention and treatment. SAMHSA has funded programs in the following areas:

- Mental health services, such as suicide prevention, integrated care, children's mental health, peer support services, treatment for children with serious emotional disturbances, adults with serious mental illness, homelessness, supported employment, services addressing trauma, and training and technical assistance
- Substance use prevention services, such as prevention of underage drinking, substance use, and HIV
- Substance use treatment services, such as drug courts, adult re-entry, recovery support services, homelessness, and treatment for substance use and/or co-occurring disorders

Grant funds are available from the following SAMHSA centers and offices:

- [Center for Mental Health Services \(CMHS\)](#)
- [Center for Substance Abuse Prevention \(CSAP\)](#)
- [Center for Substance Abuse Treatment \(CSAT\)](#)
- [988 & Behavioral Health Crisis Coordinating Office \(BHCCO\)](#)



Chapter 2: Preparing Ahead

Overview

This chapter discusses steps you can take to prepare your organization to be ready when grant funding is announced. The time frame for grant application development is very short—usually limited to 60 days. Advanced planning and organizing will give you a head start and help make the process of preparing your application more efficient.

Keep Your Program and Organizational Materials Up to Date

Update your organizational materials and key documents on a regular basis so you are not starting from scratch when it comes time to begin developing your grant application. Review past notices of funding opportunities (NOFOs) and anticipate what information and documents you will likely need to include in your application. Prepare as much as you can in advance to maximize the time you will have to respond to the NOFO when it is released.

NOFOs often require the following materials as part of the grant application:

Program/Organizational Information

- Certifications/licensure
- Key community partnerships
- Referral sources
- Consent forms

TIP



Keep your organization's documents and materials up to date to be better prepared when the NOFO is released.

Evidence-Based Practices (EBPs)

- Description of EBPs being used
- Research justifying use of the EBPs with your population of focus
- How staff are trained to implement the EBPs
- How fidelity of the EBPs is monitored
- Justification of any modifications that have been made to the EBPs

Staff and Organizational Experience

- Job descriptions of staff
- Resumes of key management personnel and staff providing services
- Experience of your organization managing grants and providing services

Data

- Data specific to your population(s) of focus, such as numbers served, demographic characteristics, and number/type of services delivered
- Local statistics and census data
- Outcome data
- Data collection instruments and procedures
- Information on service gaps

Build and Strengthen Connections

Connecting with organizations and groups within and beyond your community can help your program make a greater impact. Developing these connections allows you to maximize your resources, leverage different experiences, and expand your reach. By showing that you are engaged in collaborative efforts—such as through partnerships, networks, coalitions, and advisory committees—you can strengthen the credibility of your organization and increase its capacity to successfully achieve its goals and objectives.

Small organizations and organizations in rural communities can especially benefit from these collaborative relationships. Building effective collaborations can help overcome challenges such as limited resources, sparse populations, geographical isolation, and limited access to technical experts.

Partnerships and Networks

Partnerships and networks bring community organizations and groups together to work toward a shared goal. NOFOs often ask you to discuss these collaborative relationships to demonstrate your involvement with other organizations within the community.

Some benefits of partnerships and networks include:

- Increased support for your project and improved likelihood for sustainability
- Opportunities for alternative funding
- Shared information about your community
- Shared resources and data
- Buy-in and validation for your project
- Improved public relations for your organization
- Increased community dialogue at all levels for project design and service delivery
- Lessons learned and feedback to help you design effective services

Coalitions

Coalitions help to unify people, programs, and organizations around a common purpose and move the whole community toward positive social change. One program cannot solve all the problems in a community. Coalition building brings together varied programs in your community—such as health, religious, school, social services, and housing programs—to work to achieve shared goals. By contributing to coalition building, you can help to broaden the range of services in your area and expand the continuum of care.

Advisory Committees

Advisory committees—both local and national—are useful tools for gathering insights and guidance. A local advisory committee can be especially valuable, as it can assist your organization with tasks that match the specific needs of your community. Local advisory committee members should be local residents who are familiar with the community.

A local advisory committee may help with:

- Increasing program status in the community
- Identifying individuals in the community with expertise in program evaluation
- Project planning
- Obtaining information on past experience with grant projects and input on a variety of fields, such as accounting, medicine, research, fundraising, and marketing
- Recruiting focus group participants and encouraging consumer/client involvement

A local advisory committee should:

- Represent the demographics that exist within your community
- Include members that represent the population(s) of focus
- Include members with access to resources, expertise, information, and/or funding sources that your organization can benefit and learn from
- Meet on a regular basis

Identify Potential Funding Opportunities and Conduct a Literature Search

Familiarize yourself with current and emerging SAMHSA projects that match your interests and needs.

- Review the grants on the SAMHSA website that have been announced in the past several years to get an idea of the types of grants that may be announced in the future.
- Check the [SAMHSA Grant Announcements](#) webpage for the forecast of grants anticipated to be released in the upcoming fiscal year—the forecast is posted prior to the start of the new fiscal year, which begins on October 1.
- Review newsletters from professional organizations and national associations, as they often highlight federal grant programs well in advance of the official notice.

If you find a potential funding opportunity of interest, take advantage of the lead time and begin collecting information and ideas about how you might address the problem area within your community or population(s) of focus. It may be helpful to conduct a literature search ahead of time. The information you collect can be useful as you develop your grant application.

Consider the following as you conduct your literature search:

- Be as specific as possible—Use search words or phrases that specifically focus on your project service area, population(s) of focus, methodology, and project performance assessment plan.
- Refer to the SAMHSA website for information and resources that are available from other sources.
- Collect information that will be useful in your Project Narrative, such as information that you can use to describe your population of focus and statement of need, proposed implementation approach, and proposed evidence-based services/practices.
- Familiarize yourself with the SAMHSA [Evidence-Based Practices Resource Center](#).

Plan a Community Needs Assessment

A community needs assessment can help you develop sections of your application, such as the population of focus and statement of need. The community needs assessment will also help you establish a baseline for your project, which you will use for your statement of need. The baseline provides an accurate appraisal of the current situation that you seek to change.

TIP



Key federal data sources:

- SAMHSA's [Center for Behavioral Health Statistics and Quality \(CBHSQ\)](#)
- SAMHSA's [National Survey on Drug Use and Health](#)
- CDC's [National Center for Health Statistics](#)

You can assess and document the need in your community or population(s) of focus using a variety of qualitative and quantitative approaches such as:

- Compile existing data—gather and compare national, state, and local information and data collected by individual agencies, state and county public agencies, school systems, health systems, and court systems.
- Conduct surveys to gather information from a representative sample of your population(s) of focus.
- Use the key informant approach—identify and interview community leaders, stakeholders, and decision-makers who are knowledgeable about the community and can accurately identify priority needs and concerns.

- Use a community forum approach—conduct public meetings to obtain information from community members about the needs facing the community and to identify the needs that should be prioritized.

Any approach you choose to assess the needs in your community must reflect an understanding and appreciation of the characteristics of your community and population(s) of focus.

Reading and reviewing current materials written by leaders in the field can help you identify effective strategies for implementing your project. Community assessments focus on local assets, resources, and activities, as well as gaps, barriers, and emerging needs. Understanding your community will help you tailor selected strategies and activities to your specific project and population(s) of focus.

Develop an Understanding of the Financial Management of a Grant

It is important to gain an understanding of the financial processes that are involved in managing a grant. SAMHSA recipients must follow standards for financial management of grant awards, which are outlined in [2 CFR Part 200](#).

Your accounting and personnel policies and procedures must include necessary management controls to meet the federal standards. Consider if there are changes to your organization's fiscal infrastructure that would better prepare you to meet the financial management requirements.

For specific information about these necessary controls, refer to the SAMHSA [Financial Management Requirements](#) webpage.



Chapter 3: Finding the Right Funding Opportunity for Your Organization

Overview

This chapter provides information about SAMHSA grant announcements, referred to as notices of funding opportunities, or NOFOs. You will learn where to search for funding opportunities, what elements of the NOFO to review as you consider whether to apply, and who can provide assistance if you decide to apply.

Familiarize Yourself with the NOFO

SAMHSA announces the availability of grant funds through the release of NOFOs. Each NOFO includes the following:

- A description of the project
- Activities that must be implemented
- Review criteria
- Directions on how to apply
- Due date
- Eligibility requirements

You can find SAMHSA NOFO announcements by searching the SAMHSA [Grants Dashboard](#). Applications are submitted through the Grants.gov online portal.

SAMHSA strongly encourages you to sign up for [Grants.gov updates](#) to receive email notifications about grants you are interested in. By signing up, you will receive email notifications if a NOFO is cancelled or changed. You can also sign up to receive notifications when new grant opportunities are announced.

TIP



Sign up for [Grants.gov updates](#) to automatically receive NOFO notifications.

Carefully Review the NOFO

Determine if Your Organization is Eligible

Each NOFO clearly specifies who is eligible to apply. Carefully review the Eligibility section of the NOFO to determine if your organization meets the requirements. Some NOFOs limit applications to states, while others are open to any domestic public or private non-profit organization. NOFOs often state that entities that received funding under previous grant announcements are not eligible to apply.

Consider if Your Organization has the Capacity to Implement the Grant Project

Carefully review the Purpose section of the NOFO. This section will include specific information about the intent of the grant program, the population of focus, the activities you must implement, and the performance data that you must collect and report to SAMHSA. Carefully consider whether your program/organization has the infrastructure, resources, and expertise to carry out the requirements of the grant. In addition, evaluate whether your organization has the fiscal infrastructure to meet the financial management requirements and related tasks.

Review the Evaluation Criteria in the Project Narrative Section

Examine the evaluation criteria in the Project Narrative section to understand what information you must compile to respond to the criteria. A panel of peer reviewers will assess the quality of the information you present in your Project Narrative. Think about the work you do every day and whether it aligns with the purpose, goals, and objectives of the project being funded.

Take Note of Screen-Out Criteria

Some NOFOs have additional requirements that you must meet to be considered for review. The requirements are referred to as screen-out criteria. For example, the NOFO may state that you must provide a Memorandum of Understanding (MOU) with a required partner, and if you do not submit this MOU in your application package, it will be screened out.

Identify the Required Components, Attachments, and Other Forms

Review the NOFO to identify the required application components and attachments. Some NOFOs require additional forms. Assess your organization's preparedness and resources and consider if it is realistic for you to compile all the application requirements by the deadline.





Chapter 4: Completing and Submitting Your Grant Application

Overview

This chapter provides tips to consider as you develop your grant application, including steps you can take in the time leading up to the NOFO announcement.

Tips for Completing and Submitting Your Application

Complete the Three Required Registrations

You must be registered with three systems before you can apply for any SAMHSA NOFO:

- [System for Award Management \(SAM\)](#)
- [Grants.gov](#)
- [eRA Commons](#)

TIP



Start the registration process early—at least 6 weeks before the application deadline.

Refer to Section A of the [NOFO Application Guide](#) for detailed instructions on the registration process.

Learn How to Effectively Navigate Grants.gov Workspace or eRA ASSIST

SAMHSA requires applicants to electronically submit their application using [eRA ASSIST](#) or [Grants.gov Workspace](#). If you are new to these systems, you should familiarize yourself with their features and become comfortable navigating them.

Refer to Section A of the [NOFO Application Guide](#) for information on eRA ASSIST and Grants.gov Workspace.

Begin the Necessary Groundwork Before the NOFO is Announced

Prepare ahead of time so you can devote as much time as possible to writing your application. Get an early start on the following tasks:

- Check that your program materials are up to date (see [Chapter 2](#)).
- Develop a network of contacts that can help as you develop your application, such as state and local government entities, university staff, and individuals and other organizations.
- Create a committee to head up application development and get key participants on board to assist.

Establish a Timetable for Developing Your Grant Application

Establish a plan for what needs to be completed, by whom, and when. The application process is labor-intensive and there is limited time to complete and submit the application. Identify the individuals—called your grant writing team—who will complete certain tasks:

- **Writer(s)**—Although several individuals may write specific sections of the application, one person should review the entire application to make sure it flows and that nothing is left out or repeated.
- **Person or small committee removed from the process to critique the first draft and identify questions or gaps**—In particular, this individual or committee should carefully review the Project Narrative to make sure your responses are thorough and all evaluation criteria have been addressed.
- **Person to request and coordinate receipt of Letters of Commitment (LOC)**—This individual might write a draft LOC outlining how the potential partners or organizations will contribute to the proposed project. Organizations may be

willing to commit to becoming involved in the project but might not have time to draft a letter. The letters must be recent and include specific details about the roles and responsibilities of the partnering organizations. [Appendix C](#) provides a sample LOC.

[Appendix D](#) provides a sample work plan that shows how you might:

- Organize the tasks you need to complete as part of the application process
- Assign responsibility for completing each task
- Ensure you complete the tasks in time to meet the application deadline

Align Your Proposed Project with the Intent of the NOFO

It is critical that the project you are proposing fully aligns with the parameters for the project outlined in the NOFO. Carefully review the project goals, description, and evaluation criteria to ensure that your proposed project approach can fulfill the actual project requirements.

Lay Out a Master Plan for Your Project

Your application needs a master plan—a vision of where the project is going and the expected results. The master plan should address the key questions of who, what, where, when, and why. Your application should include realistic goals, measurable objectives, tasks required to accomplish the objectives, and a methodology to evaluate accomplishments.

Within the required page limits for the Project Narrative, describe how you will implement your project. Be thorough, but do not provide unnecessary detail. Provide evidence-based justification for your goals and a convincing description of how and why you think you will be able to accomplish them.

Leverage Resources and Supports from Outside Your Organization

- **SAMHSA staff**—SAMHSA staff members are available to answer questions about eligibility, grants management, budget issues, and project requirements. Each NOFO provides contact information for SAMHSA agency contacts.
- **State Point of Contact (SPOC)**—If your state has a designated SPOC, you will need to notify them that you are applying for a federal grant. Your SPOC may be able to recommend sources for free training and technical assistance. (This requirement does not apply to applications submitted by states and American Indian/Alaska Native tribes or tribal organizations.)
- **Single State Agency (SSA)**—The SSA for drug and alcohol abuse and for mental health may provide technical assistance and assist you with identifying opportunities for funding, training, and networking. You can find your SSA for substance abuse and SSA for mental health on the SAMHSA [Application Forms and Resources](#) webpage.
- **Project partnerships and community groups**—Communicate with partners, coalition groups, advocates, and other resource people about your project design and performance assessment plan. Discuss your ideas with them or set up a focus group to test your project plans and obtain feedback.
- **Consumers, clients, and families**—Individuals and families who access your services are excellent sources of information about improvements that would enhance your organization's services. Set up meetings and focus groups with these individuals to obtain needs assessment information.
- **Pre-application webinars**—Pre-application webinars are held for some NOFOs. Webinars are announced on the grant announcement

page, in the “Application Materials” box. You can find grant announcements by searching the SAMHSA [Grants Dashboard](#).

- **Frequently asked questions (FAQs)**—FAQs for specific NOFOs may be posted in the “Application Materials” box on the grant announcement page. In addition, see the [Grants Frequently Asked Questions](#) webpage.

Follow Instructions for Formatting Your Application

Carefully review the formatting requirements for your application. An application that does not follow the required format may not be forwarded for review.

TIP



Submit your application at least 24 to 72 hours before it is due.

Consider the following when formatting your application:

- Pay attention to the **page limit**.
- Consider putting a header at the top of each page of your Project Narrative to clearly show how many pages have been used (for example, Page 1 of 10, Page 2 of 10, etc.).
- Save space in your Project Narrative by putting your citations in an attachment but note in your Project Narrative where the citations are located. Label the attachment “Citations.”
- Note that SAMHSA does not require that you use a specific citation style.
- Pay attention to the required font size.
- Include all attachments in PDF format.

Refer to the SAMHSA.gov [Formatting Requirements](#) webpage for more details on application formatting and validation requirements.

Make a Reasonable Funding Request and Match Your Budget to the Scope of Work

Your budget request must clearly reflect the project scope. Be specific and justify each item for all years of support you are requesting. The funds you request per year cannot exceed the dollar limit noted in the NOFO. Apply only for the grant amount that you can reasonably spend, based on the activities you will implement and the number of clients you plan to serve annually (see [Chapter 7](#)).

Thoroughly Address all Participant Protection Elements

Unless otherwise noted, all applicants for SAMHSA funding must address confidentiality and participant protection guidelines.

Consider the following when responding to this section:

- You must address all the participant protection elements.
- Most of the elements have multiple components, and you must address **all components**.
- If any of the components are not applicable to your project, explain why.

It is not acceptable to just include a statement that you will obtain approval of the project through your organization's Institutional Review Board (IRB) or to just insert a copy of your Policy and Procedure Manual. Even if an IRB will review your application, you must thoroughly address all the components of participant protection in your application (see [Chapter 6](#)).

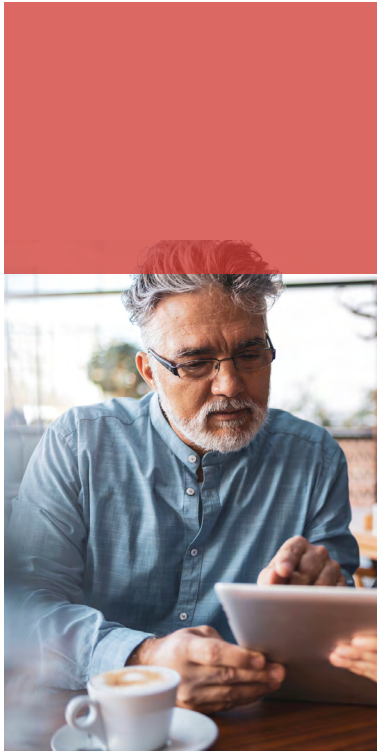
Submit Your Application Early

SAMHSA recommends that you submit your application at least 24 to 72 hours before the deadline. You will need time to resolve any issues or technical problems that may arise. Submitting early also leaves time to fix submission errors and resubmit your application, if needed.

You must monitor your application through both Grants.gov and eRA because both systems can reject the application. **You are responsible for viewing and tracking your application to ensure it was submitted successfully.**

Refer to Section A of the [NOFO Application Guide](#) for instructions on submitting your application and how to check your application status.





Chapter 5: Writing a Comprehensive Project Narrative

Overview

The Project Narrative describes what you intend to do in your project. This chapter provides an overview of the information you will likely need to include in each section of your Project Narrative. It also includes tips for you to consider as you respond to the evaluation criteria, as well as critiques of actual responses to evaluation criteria.

Project Narrative: Responding to the Evaluation Criteria

In your Project Narrative, you will describe your proposed project by responding to the evaluation criteria provided in the NOFO. The Project Narrative generally includes the following evaluation criteria sections:

- [Population of focus and need statement](#)
- [Proposed implementation approach](#)
- [Proposed evidence-based, evidence-informed, and/or community-defined practices](#)
- [Organizational experience and staffing](#)
- [Data collection and performance measurement](#)

The NOFO provides a point value for each section of the Project Narrative. The total point value is 100. Peer reviewers evaluate your responses to the evaluation criteria and assign a score for each section.

Key points to consider as you develop your Project Narrative:

- Include the section letter and number (e.g., A.1, B.2) **before your response to each criterion**. You do not need to include the full criterion in each section of your Project Narrative.
- Address all components for each criterion and respond to each component individually. Many of the criteria have multiple components. Example: The following criterion has five components:
(1) Describe the experience of your organization with similar projects and/or (2) providing services to the population(s) of focus for this NOFO. (3) Identify other organization(s) that you will partner with in the proposed project. (4) Describe their experience providing services to the population(s) of focus, and their (5) specific roles and responsibilities for this project.
- Provide **explicit detail** for **all** your responses to the evaluation criteria. Do not simply restate the information in the NOFO. The detail you provide should directly relate to the criterion you are addressing.
- Succinctly describe your project and how you will implement it. Do not include unnecessary detail or information that is not relevant to the criteria. Example: Some applicants provide a lot of detail about research related to the EBPs they plan to implement and a detailed description of how they will implement them. This level of detail is not required by the criterion.
- Consider the assigned point value and recommended page limit for each section of the Project Narrative. This information is provided in the NOFO. The number of pages you allocate to each section should generally align with the point value.
- Include information in the appropriate criterion section. Do not refer to information in another section. Reviewers will only consider information that is in the appropriate criterion section.
- Carefully read each criterion and provide a response to exactly what is asked for. Example: If a criterion asks you to discuss how **key staff members** have demonstrated experience with and are qualified to serve the population(s) of focus, you must discuss the qualifications of specific key staff members, **not** the experience of your organization.
- Explain why you haven't provided requested information, if applicable. If an evaluation criterion asks for information that is not available, explain why this information is not available and what your plan is to collect it.
- Avoid using vague words, such as "ongoing" or "regular." Be as specific as possible.
- Spell out all acronyms when you first use them.
- If you have questions or need clarification about the evaluation criteria, contact the program staff identified in the NOFO under Agency Contacts.



Population of Focus and Need Statement

In this section, you will describe the unmet need(s) or emerging problem(s) that your project will address, who your project will serve/train (population of focus), and where your project will deliver services/training (geographic catchment area).

You will likely need to include the following information in this section:

- The specific geographic catchment area where you will implement the project
- The population(s) of focus
- The demographic characteristics of the population(s) of focus
- The nature of the problem within the geographic catchment area, including the extent of need, barriers to care, and gaps in service for the population(s) of focus
- The need for greater capacity in your organization to address the identified need

You must include current quantitative data to support the need for your project among the population(s) of focus and within your geographic catchment area. You must cite your sources of data.

Sources of local data may include:

- State and county public agencies
- School systems
- Court systems
- HIV/AIDS planning councils
- Community health assessments
- Arrest data
- United Way organizations
- Hospitals

Sources of national data may include:

- U.S. Census Bureau
- SAMHSA
- Other federal agencies, such as the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC) and the Health Resources and Services Administration (HRSA)

Refer to [Appendix G](#) for other sources of quantitative data.

You may further support the need for your project by including qualitative data, such as data collected from focus groups with consumers, clients, family members of consumers, and other key constituents or informants. Refer to [Chapter 2](#) for additional information on [obtaining qualitative and quantitative data](#).

TIPS FOR



Responding to the Population of Focus and Need Statement evaluation criterion.

- Clearly define the population(s) of focus.
- Be realistic when considering the size of the population of focus. Example: Serving both undergraduate and graduate students on a university campus with more than 40,000 students may not be realistic.
- Include demographic information for your population of focus. [Appendix E](#) provides examples for displaying demographic information in table format.
- Clearly define the geographic catchment area. Example: If your project will be implemented in New York City, be specific about whether the catchment area will include the entire city or certain boroughs.

- Explain why you selected the specific geographic catchment area.
- Use current data when describing the need for the project. If current data is not available, note this and explain why.
- Use local data that is specific to your community if you are describing a need in your community. It is not sufficient to just cite state and/or national data. If local data is not available, note this and explain how you plan to collect it.
- If your project will provide services to a specific population, include data specific to that population within the geographic catchment area in your need statement. Example: If your project will focus on suicide prevention among youth and young adults ages 24 and younger, include data on suicide rates for that specific age range within your geographic catchment area, not just data on suicide rates in the state.
- Cite all sources of data. You can put citations in an attachment—they do not need to be in the Project Narrative.

Proposed Implementation Approach

In this section, you will describe the goals and measurable objectives of your project. You will also explain how you plan to implement the required activities.

You may need to include the following information in this section:

- The purpose of the proposed project
- Realistic goals and measurable objectives that align with your statement of need
- The unduplicated number of individuals to be served/trained by the project
- A timeline for the entire project period
- An explanation of how you will implement all the required activities

TIPS FOR



Responding to the Proposed Implementation Approach evaluation criterion.

- Develop realistic goals and measurable objectives that align with your statement of need. Each objective must be linked to a specific goal. Refer to the SAMHSA.gov [Developing Goals and Measurable Objectives](#) webpage for guidance on developing goals and measurable objectives.
- Consider what data you will need to be able to evaluate whether your objectives have been achieved. You will describe your data collection plan in the Data Collection and Performance Measurement section of your Project Narrative.
- You may find it helpful to display your goals and objectives in a table. See the SAMHSA [Developing the Plan for Data Collection and Performance Measurement](#) webpage for a sample table.
- Concisely but thoroughly describe how you will implement all the required activities in your project, as well as any allowable activities you have selected.
- Develop a realistic plan to implement the project. Reviewers will evaluate the feasibility of implementing all components of the project. Example: If you propose to implement 10 EBPs, the reviewers will expect you to explain how you will realistically train staff on all the EBPs and how you will effectively monitor the delivery of all the EBPs to ensure that they are delivered according to EBP guidelines.
- Include a timeline that covers the entire project period, not just the first year.
- Identify the specific staff members who will be responsible for the tasks included in the timeline, not the organization that will be responsible.

- In your timeline, include all key tasks described in the required activities section that must be completed by a specific date. For example, one required activity may be submitting a needs assessment within three months of the award.
- Present the activities in your timeline in a logical sequence and allocate enough time for each task. [Appendix B](#) provides a sample timeline and additional guidance on developing a timeline.

Proposed Evidence-Based, Evidence-Informed, and/or Community-Defined Practices

In this section, you will identify the evidence-based practice(s), evidence-informed practice(s), and/or community-defined practice(s) you plan to use for your project. You will need to explain how each intervention is appropriate for your population(s) of focus.

You may need to include the following information in this section:

- A description of the practices you plan to implement, including why each is appropriate for the problem your project will address and your population(s) of focus
- Specific information about any modifications you plan to make to the practice(s) and your reason for making these modifications
- How you plan to monitor the implementation of the practice(s) to ensure they are implemented according to practice guidelines

If you plan to implement services or practices that are not evidence-based, you must show that these services or practices are effective. You will need to cite sources, such as articles from research journals, to document the effectiveness of these services or practices. If this type of information is unavailable, you may provide information from other sources, such as unpublished studies or documents describing formal consensus among recognized experts.

You may choose to implement services that you can show have been successful but that have not been proven successful in your population of focus or community. This is acceptable, but you must thoroughly explain what you are trying to do, your expected outcomes, what you will do to modify the project if needed, and why you believe these modifications will improve the project. Your explanation must be based on evidence from the field and supported with sources.

TIPS FOR



Responding to the Evidence-Based or Evidence-Informed Practices evaluation criterion.

- Clearly describe **why** you chose the specific practice(s) for your project.
- Explain how the practice(s) are appropriate for the population(s) of focus and the outcomes you want to achieve. If you state that a practice has been found to be effective with a specific population, you must include literature citations to support this statement.
- Use the [Evidence-Based Practices Resource Center](#) as a resource for guidance on incorporating EBPs in your project.

Organizational Experience and Staffing

In this section, you will describe your organization's capability to implement the project, experience providing services to the population(s) of focus, and experience with similar projects.

You will likely need to include the following information in this section:

- Your organization's experience with similar projects and experience providing services to the population(s) of focus

- The capability and experience of organizations you will partner with for the project
- A list of all key staff for the project, including their roles, level of effort (LOE), and qualifications, including their experience providing services to the population(s) of focus and their familiarity with its culture(s) and language(s)

TIPS FOR



Responding to the Organizational Experience and Staffing evaluation criterion.

- In your description of your organization's experience with similar projects, clearly describe your organization's experience collecting data and reporting on performance measures for similar projects, types of evaluations conducted, and outcomes achieved. If you plan to have an evaluator from outside your organization conduct the performance assessment, such as a professor from a local university, describe this person's experience with federally funded projects, including the collection, analysis, and reporting of data and other performance measures.
- If you have partners that will participate in the project, describe their roles and responsibilities specific to your proposed project. It is not sufficient to just describe the services your partners provide. Include a Letter of Commitment for each partner in the attachment specified in the NOFO. [Appendix C](#) provides a sample letter of commitment.
- Describe each individual staff member's specific experience providing services to the population(s) of focus and their familiarity with the culture(s) and language(s) of the population. It is not sufficient to indicate that "he/she serves the population of focus and understands its culture." It is also not sufficient to provide a

general statement that all staff members have experience with the population of focus.

- Make sure the LOE for the Project Director or other management or supervisory staff is sufficient to effectively oversee the project. If the LOE for the Project Director is relatively low, identify the staff members who will be responsible for managing the grant and explain this in the Project Narrative.
- If the NOFO indicates that Key Personnel, such as the Project Director, must have a certain LOE, make sure the LOE for your Key Personnel meet that requirement. Check that the LOE in this section and the LOE in your budget match.
- Include all the required information for project staff, such as qualifications, roles, and LOE. You may want to use a table to clearly outline this information for reviewers and help to ensure you have included all information the NOFO asks for. [Appendix F](#) provides a sample table that shows how this information might be displayed. Include all staff members identified in this section in the budget and narrative justification.

Data Collection and Performance Measurement

All federal programs require that performance data be collected and reported. In this section, you will document how you will collect and report on the required performance measures and describe your performance assessment plan. The NOFO will include information on the data to be collected and reported, what instruments are to be used, and how the data are to be submitted.

You may need to include the following information in this section:

- The data collection instruments you will use
- How you will collect the data and what staff member(s) will oversee the data collection

- How you will use the data collected to manage, monitor, and enhance the program
- How you plan to conduct the performance assessment
- The quality improvement process you will implement

TIPS FOR



Responding to the Data Collection and Performance Measurement evaluation criterion.

- Identify what data (i.e., performance indicators) you will use to determine whether you are achieving your goals and objectives.
- Explain your plan for reviewing and reporting on progress in achieving your goals and objectives and discuss your approach to addressing and overcoming barriers in meeting your goals and objectives.
- Identify who will be responsible for collecting, analyzing, and reporting on the data that will be used in your performance assessment. Your local university may have experts in the performance assessment field who could help.
- If an evaluation team will be responsible for data analysis and reporting, specify the individuals who will be on this team.
- If possible, consider involving an evaluator in your project from the start to help you identify the tools and techniques that can be used for the project.
- Integrate all performance assessment components—goals and objectives, assessment questions, methodology, instruments, analysis, and Government Performance and Results Act (GPRA) requirements.
- Refer to the SAMHSA.gov [Developing the Plan for Data Collection and Performance Measurement](#) webpage for more information.



Critiques of Applicant Responses

The following are examples of applicants' responses to specific evaluation criteria and peer reviewers' critiques of those responses.

Weakness: Not specifically responding to the criteria

Evaluation Criterion: Describe the Evidence-Based Practice(s) (EBPs) that will be used to help implement the program and justify its use for your population(s) of focus, program, and the intent of the NOFO.

Applicant's Response: The Community Recovery Project is a comprehensive approach to suicide elimination utilizing the public health model to fulfill the identified elements of the National Strategy for Suicide Prevention. Evidence-based interventions are proposed at all levels of the public health model to ensure the maximum number of intercepts in order to prevent deaths by suicide in the identified population and sub-populations. To be effective, comprehensive programming focused on strategies to address issues in the individual, the environment, and the means. Interventions that target individuals, such as immediate access to integrated medical and behavioral health services, combine with interventions targeting the environment, such as seamless care coordination, effective sharing and uses of data, peer and family supports, and strong community-based prevention initiatives, that combine with interventions designed to disrupt the means of suicide and reduce access to lethal means from the architecture of this proposal.

Critique: *The applicant organization notes its understanding of the need for evidence-based practices and its plans for incorporating them in the project. However, it does not identify any specific EBPs it will implement in the project.*

Weakness: Not specifically responding to the criteria

Evaluation Criterion: Describe how you will identify, recruit, and retain the population of focus.

Applicant's Response: In alignment with best practices, this program has created numerous referral sources and will ensure that all clients receive a high level of care and quality of treatment. The program has been adapted to better meet the needs of clients with co-occurring disorders and utilizes EBPs and practices to engage and retain clients. The program also keeps track of retention rates and reviews these retention rates to identify factors contributing to the rates as part of the quality improvement process.

Critique: *Although the applicant outlines its approach to the provision of services, it does not specifically address **how** it will identify, recruit, or retain clients.*

Weakness: Not specifically responding to the criteria

Evaluation Criteria: Describe how the community-based organization will change community norms to prevent and reduce substance use/HIV.

Applicant's Response: The Center has a rich history of addressing HIV in local communities. In 2000, the Center received funding to establish a statewide HIV Education Center to address the needs of young adults living with HIV/AIDS. A partnership was established with the local university and an organization conducting HIV prevention activities. In that time, the Center conducted community assessments, held focus groups, and established a national research committee to address HIV/ AIDS prevention in young adults. Data gathered from this intervention was used to develop strategies for the prevention of HIV/AIDS in young adults. As such, the Center will build upon this experience and its 15-year history of educating the community on methods to prevent and reduce substance use and HIV/AIDS.

Critique: *The applicant organization provides information about how it has been involved in addressing HIV. However, it does not specifically document **how it will** change community norms to prevent and reduce substance use/HIV. It mentions that it will work to educate the community on methods to prevent and reduce substance use and HIV/AIDS but does not provide any specific information about **how** it will do this.*

Weakness: Lack of detail/specific information related to the criterion

Evaluation Criterion: Describe how you will identify, recruit, and retain the population of focus.

Applicant's Response: We are well-established as a resource in the health and human services community, with long and productive relationships with most referring agencies in our area, including the County Health Department, the University Health Center, and the Local Management Board. We play a key role in providing health information from the Health Department, the University, and others to women with substance use and mental health problems, including homeless women. We have credibility with the target population due to our long history of providing responsive services. We also do a considerable amount of outreach work centered around health education and HIV. We sponsor and/or attend multiple health fairs every year, conduct door-to-door activities, provide basic social services and assistance, and draw clients from our exercise classes, cooking classes, and other community wellness programs. These services also help us both recruit and retain participants.

Critique: *Although this applicant describes its collaborative relationship with other organizations and its provision of outreach and other services in the community, it does not provide **specific** information about **how** it will identify, recruit, and retain the population of focus. For example, within the larger group of individuals it provides services to, the applicant does not describe **how** it will identify the population of focus, **what** techniques/methods it will use to recruit the individuals to be involved in the project after it has identified them, and **what** specific strategies it will implement to retain these individuals in the project. In addition, the applicant states that the services it provides helps it recruit and retain participants but does not provide any documentation to support this assertion.*

Weakness: Lack of detail/specific information related to the criterion

Evaluation Criterion: Explain how you will monitor the delivery of the EBPs to ensure that they are implemented according to the EBP guidelines.

Applicant's Response: As research demonstrates that poorly executed EBP programs are seldom successful in achieving positive outcomes, the agency will monitor program delivery by requiring partners to work in conjunction with the project staff to assess the needs and identify appropriate evidence-based interventions, provide training and technical assistance, and hone current systems to improve adherence to fidelity of the EBPs to ensure that the EPBs are delivered according to EBP guidelines.

Critique: *The applicant organization provides a limited response. There is a lack of detail on **how** training and technical assistance will be provided (who will conduct the training/TA with partners, **how often** will it be conducted, the staff members that will be required to attend) and the monitoring processes will be implemented (**what** processes or tools will be used – onsite, self-assessment, focus groups, **who** will be responsible for overseeing the monitoring, and the **frequency** of monitoring). There is also no specific information about **what** changes would be made to the supervision of individuals delivering the EBPs based on the results of the monitoring that is conducted.*

Weakness: Lack of detail/specific information related to the criterion

Evaluation Criterion: Describe the quality improvement process that will be used to track whether your performance measures and objectives are being met, and how these data will inform the ongoing implementation of the project.

Applicant's Response: An overall goal of the evaluation is to provide feedback to inform and support implementation and improvement. Staff will deliver information summaries on a regular basis to encourage improvements in coordination and service delivery as the project unfolds. Regularly scheduled meetings between the Evaluator, Project Director, and sub-grantee staff will encourage data-driven dialogue about project successes, barriers, and potential solutions to those barriers. Sub-grantees may make adjustments to program implementation as needed based on evaluation reports.

Critique: *The applicant organization does not provide adequate specificity about the quality improvement process. For example, **what** information will be included in the information summaries? **What** monitoring tools will be used to collect this information? **How** will the information be collected? For example, will a satisfaction survey be conducted or input obtained from consumer advisory boards? In addition, on a regular basis or regularly scheduled meetings needs to be more clearly defined. Finally, it is not fully evident **what** processes will be put into place to ensure that both the applicant and the sub-recipients implement the necessary adjustments, such as monthly quality improvement meetings or monthly trainings to address changes that need to be made to the clinical and/or administrative operations of the project.*

Weakness: Lack of detail/specific information related to the criterion

Evaluation Criterion: Describe how your staff will ensure the input of patients in assessing, planning, and implementing your project.

Applicant's Response: Patient engagement is critical to the development of the project. The organization is committed to outreach and active engagement of patients, partners, and stakeholders to ensure the best possible assessment, planning, and implementation of the project. Patients will have the opportunity to engage with staff regarding the project in many ways, including but not limited to webinars, webpages, community events, and email distribution lists. Effective communication and feedback from patients regarding issues, concerns, and recommendations for the project will help assure that the Department is fully informed.

Critique: *The applicant organization does not provide **specific** information about the strategies that will used to solicit input from patients, at what point in the process this input will be obtained (assessment, planning, or implementation) or **how** this input will be utilized.*

Weakness: Lack of detail/specific information related to the criterion

Evaluation Criterion: Discuss the capacity and experience of the applicant organization with similar projects and populations. Demonstrate that the applicant organization has linkages to the population(s) of focus and ties to grassroots/community-based organizations that are rooted in the culture(s) and languages(s) of the population(s) of focus.

Applicant's Response: The applicant, the County Department of Behavioral Health (CDBH), provides care and treatment to adults, children, and adolescents with mental illness, substance use disorders, and intellectual disabilities, through county-operated programs and contracts with community agencies. Services include intensive short-term treatment as well as extended care of persons with serious mental illness. The partnership between CDBH and the Drug Court ensures that clients of the Drug Court have immediate access to the full gamut of treatment services for co-occurring disorders provided by the CDBH. CDBH has developed a vast network of treatment and recovery support service providers, including faith-based organizations. Connection to the population(s) of focus has increased due to the availability of faith-based and multicultural organizations that provide services that are responsive to sex, race, ethnicity, and language. These services are also provided in multiple languages.

Critique: *(The applicant was responding to a NOFO funding Drug Court projects). The applicant does not document any direct experience working with Drug Court programs, other than providing treatment services to Drug Court participants, or experience working with judicial staff. In addition, one of the primary populations of focus for the project is veterans but this population was not mentioned in this response. Furthermore, the applicant does not describe experience managing similar projects. Finally, the applicant provides general information about the fact that its network includes faith-based and multicultural organizations. The response must provide examples of specific grassroots/community-based organization in its network that are responsive to the culture(s) and language(s) of the population(s) of focus.*

Weakness: Directing reviewers to find the response in another numbered criterion and not providing an in-depth response to the criterion.

Evaluation Criteria: Describe the Evidence-Based Practice(s) that will be used. Document how each EBP chosen is appropriate for the outcomes you want to achieve. Justify the use of each EBP for your population of focus. Explain how the chosen EBP(s) meets SAMHSA's goals for this program.

Applicant's Response: Our choice for this project is the MISSION Model. The evidence for using this EBP is discussed in more detail below. In brief, we selected this approach because of the varied and complex needs of individuals with a co-occurring disorder (COD) in the program which includes the need for timely care coordination, COD services, vocational support, trauma-informed care, and peer support, the latter of which assists with treatment initiation and ongoing engagement. Furthermore, MISSION offers ongoing monitoring of risk and need levels along with rapid treatment plan adjustments as needed to meet the needs of clients served in the program. As described in Section B.4, MISSION has been employed in a wide range of populations and is effective in meeting client needs while working in collaboration with the courts.

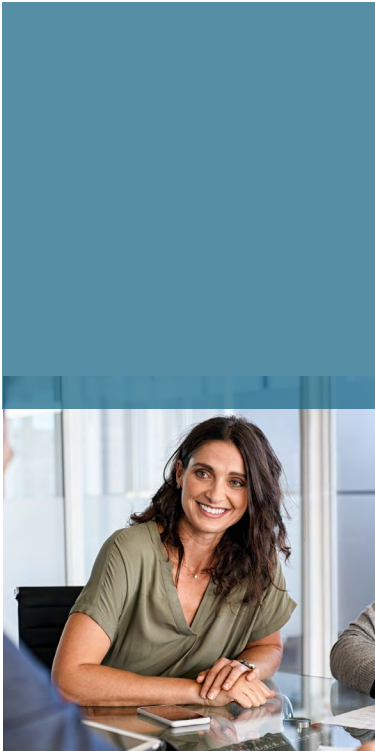
Critique: *The applicant does not include the required information in the criterion but refers to information in B.4. In addition, insufficient detail is provided about **how** this EBP is appropriate for the outcomes it seeks to achieve or **how** it meets SAMHSA's goals for the program.*

Weakness: Merely restating the information that is included in the NOFO

Evaluation Criteria: Describe your specific plan for: data collection, management, analysis, and reporting. The data collection plan must specify the staff person(s) responsible for tracking the measurable objectives that are identified in your response to B.1.

Applicant's Response: Data collection will be completed by the Clinicians and Case Managers. Progress reports and performance assessments will be completed by the Evaluator. Data will be collected at baseline, discharge, and 6 months post-baseline for a minimum of 80% of all clients who receive a baseline interview. All data will be entered into SAMHSA's GPRA data entry and reporting system within 7 business days. GPRA performance data will be reported to the public, OMB, and Congress. The evaluation plan revolves around three fundamental questions (1) What are we trying to accomplish: 2) How will we know if a change has occurred: 3) What can be measured that will indicate improvement? The project will report on the SAMHSA client-level performance measures. This information will be gathered using the SAMHSA data collection tool. The collection of this data will enable SAMHSA to report on the NOMS which have been defined by SAMHSA as key priority areas relating to substance use.

Critique: *Other than identifying the staff members who will be involved in the data collection and reporting, the applicant provides no specific information about the processes that will be implemented for this project within the organization. For example, the applicant does not specifically address **what** processes will be implemented to collect data on the objectives it identifies in B.1, **what** tools will be used to collect this data, **how** it will collect data from partners, or identify the staff member who will be responsible for tracking these objectives. This presents a significant problem as many of the objectives are not measurable. Furthermore, the applicant does not provide substantive detail on **how** data will be managed or analyzed to include information about **how** data will be protected and the role of the Evaluator in the data analysis process. Finally, information is not provided about **how** data will be reported to staff, stakeholders, and other partners.*



Chapter 6: Addressing Confidentiality and SAMHSA Participant Protection and Protection of Human Subjects Guidelines

Overview

This chapter provides an overview of SAMHSA participant protection requirements and Protection of Human Subjects Regulations.

SAMHSA Participant Protection Requirements

The NOFO describes SAMHSA requirements and federal regulations around participant protection. All applicants must address the patient protection elements as outlined in the NOFO. Your responses to these elements should describe how you will address confidentiality and protect participants from risks associated with their participation in your project. This part of the application is not optional unless otherwise noted.

Confidentiality is particularly important in SAMHSA grant projects because of the potential for stigmatization of participants receiving treatment or counseling for drug use, mental illness, HIV/AIDS, and related problems. If participants in your proposed project might be exposed to risks as a result of any failure of your project to keep their information confidential, you must develop procedures to help prevent these risks and clearly describe them in your application.

Keep in mind the following confidentiality requirements:

- Recipients who provide substance use/misuse diagnosis, treatment, or referral for treatment must maintain the confidentiality of any patient or client records for alcohol or drug use treatment. All recipients must act in accordance with [Title 42 of the Code of Federal Regulations, Part 2 \(42 CFR Part 2\)](#), Confidentiality of Substance Use Disorder Patient Records.

- Confidentiality regulations apply to any information obtained by a federally assisted project, as defined in regulations, about patients who use alcohol and other drugs.
- Projects that offer treatment for mental illness must maintain confidentiality in accordance with professional standards of practice and applicable law.

Read the information and directions in the NOFO carefully. **Most of the participant protection elements include multiple components. You must address all the components for each element. Note: In the [NOFO Application Guide](#), there are three different sections relating to participant protection. In the NOFO, you will be directed to the section of the Application Guide that is applicable for the grant you are applying for.**

- Section B is for applicants for services grants
- Section C is for applicants for training grants
- Section D is for applicants for capacity building grants

There are no page limits in this section, so you may want to insert each bullet in your response and then write the response to the bullet. This will help ensure that you have addressed all the components for each element. It may also make it easier for the peer reviewers to evaluate your responses to each component.

Protection of Human Subjects

SAMHSA expects that most grant recipients will not have to comply with the [Protection of Human Subjects Regulations](#). However, if your project involves conducting research with human subjects, you are required to obtain approval by an IRB.

You do not need IRB approval at the time of award, but you must provide documentation of approval to the Government Project Officer (GPO) before you enroll participants.

If your program must comply with Human Subjects Regulations, in your application you must:

- Explain how your organization will obtain IRB approval.
- Provide documentation that your organization has an “Assurance of Compliance” on file with the Office for Human Research Protections (OHRP).

For information about Human Subjects Regulations, refer to the OHRP website at www.hhs.gov/ohrp/index.html or call (240) 453–6900. For SAMHSA-specific questions, contact the GPO listed in Agency Contacts in the NOFO.





Chapter 7: Preparing Your Budget

Overview

In this chapter, you will learn about SAMHSA's requirements for the project budget and factors to consider as you develop your project budget.

Guidelines for Preparing Your Budget

SAMHSA requires that applicants submit the following two items to document and explain their project budget:

- SF-424A budget form
- Budget narrative

SF-424A Budget Form

In the SF-424A form, you will include your projection of all costs for all years of the grant. You must stay within the funding limits for the grant. Carefully follow the instructions included with the SF-424A when preparing your budget.

Refer to the SAMHSA [Application Forms and Resources](#) webpage for sample SF-424A forms.

Budget Narrative

In your budget narrative, you will explain how your organization will use the funds you are requesting. You will need to detail all proposed costs in your budget, broken out by the cost categories where you are requesting funds.

Your budget narrative must show that you will spend grant funds in compliance with grant provisions and federal regulations. It is important to review the funding restrictions in the NOFO and in the NOFO Application Guide. SAMHSA reviews the proposed budget and budget narrative to ensure costs are reasonable, allocable, necessary, and allowable per the Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) and cost principles (see [Appendix A](#) for definitions of these terms).

It is **highly recommended** that you use the budget narrative template on the SAMHSA.gov [Application Forms and Resources](#) webpage. You will find the template in the “**SAMHSA Budget Template**” section of that webpage.

Documenting and Justifying Your Budget

The [NOFO Application Guide](#) includes instructions for preparing the project budget and the narrative justification.

Key Points to Consider

- Align your budget with your Project Narrative. The activities, resources, staff, and other items you have described in your Project Narrative must be referenced in your budget. Example: All staff members involved in the project must be included in the Personnel or Contractual sections of the budget, even if they will not receive a salary from the project.
- Justify why all resources, staff, and supplies are included in your budget.
- Check that your total cost is equal to the indirect costs plus the direct costs (see [Glossary](#) for definitions).
- Refer to the Application Guide for information about the indirect cost rate and how to apply for an indirect cost rate.

- If your budget includes multiple years, include a cost-of-living raise in staff salaries and allow for inflation for supplies, utilities, etc.
- Be realistic about the amount of funds you will spend during the first year of the project, particularly relative to salaries and contracts. Example: If you estimate it will take 2 months to recruit and hire staff, make sure your salary figures for the first year reflect only 10 months of salary and fringe benefits for the new staff.
- Contact the Division of Grants Management if you have any questions. The contact information is listed under Agency Contacts in the NOFO.

Budget Cost Categories

The primary cost categories found in project budgets are listed below, along with tips for addressing these categories.

A. Personnel

- The Project Director name, base salary, and percentage LOE must be listed in the budget narrative justification, including in-kind, and must match the name listed on the SF-424, section 8f.
- List all staff positions by title.
- If a staff member has not been identified, you may write “To Be Hired” as the Name.
- Provide the annual salary rate and the percentage of time to be devoted to the project for each staff member involved in the project.
- Compensation paid for employees engaged in grant activities must be consistent with that paid for similar work within your organization.
- Make sure the job titles for the Key Personnel you list in the Personnel table are identical to the job titles for Key Personnel specified in the NOFO.
- If the NOFO specifies a LOE requirement for Key Personnel, make sure your budget matches the required LOE.

As a general rule, salary rates of pay should not exceed an Executive Level II salary rate. You can find the Executive Level II salary on the SAMHSA.gov [Standard Terms and Conditions](#) webpage. This amount reflects an individual's base salary exclusive of fringe and any income that an individual may be permitted to earn outside of the duties to your organization. This salary limitation also applies to sub-awards/sub-contracts under a SAMHSA grant or cooperative agreement.

Individuals and companies involved in drafting or preparing the grant application cannot be paid as consultants or contractors on the grant ([45 CFR § 75.328](#) – Competition).

The salaries of administrative and clerical staff are usually treated as Facilities and Administrative (F&A) costs, which are indirect costs ([45 CFR § 75.413c](#)). Direct charging of these costs may be appropriate only if all the following conditions are met: (1) administrative or clerical services are directly integral to a project or activity; (2) individuals involved can be specifically identified with the project or activity; and (3) the costs are not also claimed as indirect costs.

B. Fringe benefits

- Apply fringe benefits for the personnel listed in the “[Personnel](#)” budget category and only for the percentage of time devoted to the project.
- Fringe benefits may include, but are not limited to, the cost of leave, employee health insurance, pensions, and unemployment benefit plans.
- Include your organization's fringe benefit rate in your budget narrative.

Fringe benefits charged to an award must comply with HHS regulations ([45 CFR § 75.431](#) Compensation – fringe benefits).

C. Travel

- Include costs for travel required by the grant and explain the need for all travel costs.
- Include travel costs for only for project staff identified in the “Personnel” budget category.
- Include travel for consultants and contractors in the “[Contracts](#)” budget category, along with consultant and contractor fees.
- Include travel for training participants, advisory committees, review panels, etc., in the “[Other](#)” budget category, itemized in the same way as this section.

Travel costs charged to an award must comply with HHS regulations at [45 CFR § 75.474](#). If your organization does not have documented travel policies, use the U.S. General Services Administration (GSA) rates ([GSA.gov/travel](#)). If your specific travel details are unknown, explain how you estimated your proposed costs.

D. Equipment

- Include items of equipment that cost \$10,000 or more and have a useful life of more than 1 year.
- Describe relevant details, such as the type of equipment, cost, and a brief description of how you plan to use the equipment for the project.
- Explain how you estimated the equipment costs, such as using fair market value, quotes, etc.
- Include a lease versus purchase analysis that explains whether it is feasible and/or more cost-effective to lease versus purchase an item of equipment.

E. Supplies

- Include items that cost less than \$10,000 per unit—supplies often have a one-time use.
- Examples of items in this category include educational materials and office equipment, such as computers and printers.
- Describe the type of supplies to be purchased, how the supplies relate to achieving your project objectives, and how you estimated the cost of the supplies.

F. Contractual

Contractual costs are those services carried out by an individual or organization, other than your organization, in the form of a procurement relationship. The arrangement may be in the form of a sub-award, contract, consultant, or consortium agreement (see [Glossary](#) for definitions).

- List your proposed contract activities and provide a brief description of the scope of work or services to be provided.
- Justify the need for each sub-award or contract as it relates to the Project Narrative.

G. Construction – NOT ALLOWED

H. Other

- Include expenses that are not covered in any of the other budget categories in this section.
- Examples of expenses in this category include:
 - Minor alterations and renovations (define and obtain prior approval).
 - Rent (information about determining rent costs can be found on the SAMHSA Rent Worksheet).
 - Client incentives
 - Telephone and postage
 - Travel for training participants, advisory committees, etc.
 - All costs associated with training activities, except costs for consultants and contracts

Indirect Costs

For information on applying for the indirect rate, go to the HHS Program Support Center [Indirect Cost Negotiations](#) webpage. Effective with [45 CFR 75.414\(f\)](#), any non-federal entity that has never received a negotiated indirect cost rate, except for those non-federal entities described in Appendix VII part 75 (D)(1)(b), may elect to charge a de minimis rate of 15 percent of modified total direct costs (MTDC), which may be used indefinitely. If your organization has a federally approved rate of 15 percent, the approved rate will prevail.

Cost-Sharing/Matching Funds

The NOFO will specify if the program requires cost sharing/matching funds. The terms “matching” and “cost sharing” are often used interchangeably (see [Glossary](#) for definitions).

In-kind contributions are goods and services donated to the organization. These services/contributions can often be used as matching funds. Examples of in-kind contributions include:

- Corporate volunteers and pro bono professional services
- Use of a building and utilities
- Advertising
- Donation of computers or other technology resources
- Transportation

When estimating the value of in-kind contributions, base the value of these services at their market value. For example, a volunteer working in an unskilled position would be calculated at minimum wage dollar value. To indicate this in your budget, you might include a formula such as *five volunteers X hourly wage X hours per week X number of weeks*.

Appendix A: Acronyms and Glossary of Terms

Acronyms

AOR	Authorized Organization Representative
BO	Business Official
CBO	Community-Based Organization
CDC	Centers for Disease Control and Prevention
CFDA	Catalog of Federal Domestic Assistance
CFR	Code of Federal Regulations
DGM	Division of Grants Management
DGR	Division of Grant Review
EBiz POC	E-Business Point of Contact
EBP	Evidence-Based Practice
EHR	Electronic Health Record
EIN	Employer Identification Number
eRA	Electronic Research Administration
F&A	Facilities and Administrative
FTE	Full-Time Equivalent
FY	Fiscal Year
GAO	Government Accountability Office
GMO	Grants Management Officer
GMS	Grants Management Specialist
GPO	Government Project Officer
GPRA	Government Performance and Results Act
HHS	Department of Health and Human Services
HRSA	Health Resources and Services Administration

IRB	Institutional Review Board
LOC	Letter of Commitment
LOE	Level of Effort
MOU	Memorandum of Understanding
MTDC	Modified Total Direct Cost
NICRA	Negotiated Indirect Cost Rate Agreement
NoA	Notice of Award
NOFO	Notice of Funding Opportunity
NOMs	National Outcome Measures
OIG	Office of the Inspector General
PD	Project/Program Director
PHSIS	Public Health System Impact Statement
PI	Principal Investigator
PL	Public Law
PMS	Payment Management System
POF	Population of Focus
SAM	System for Award Management
SF	Standard Form
SO	Signing Official
SOC	System of Care
SPARS	SAMHSA's Performance Accountability and Reporting System
SPOC	State Point of Contact
SSA	Single State Agency
TA	Technical Assistance
UEI	Unique Entity Identifier

Glossary

Allocable Cost

A cost is allocable to the extent the services and/or goods benefit the project.

Allowable Cost

A cost incurred by a recipient is allowable if it is:

- Necessary and reasonable for the performance of the grant
- Allocable
- In conformance with any limitations or exclusions in federal cost principles
- Consistent with the applicant organization's regulations, policies, and procedures that apply to both federally supported and other activities of the organization
- Accorded consistent treatment as a direct or indirect cost
- Determined in accordance with generally accepted accounting principles
- Not included as a cost in any other federally supported award (unless specifically authorized by statute)

Authorized Organization Representative (AOR)

In Grants.gov, a member of an organization who is approved by the E-Business Point of Contact to submit grant applications in Grants.gov on behalf of the organization. Only an AOR has the authority to sign and submit grant applications.

Baseline Data

Basic information or data that is available or can be collected before a project begins. Such data is used to provide a starting point against which to compare data collected later in the project to determine if there has been a change in specific conditions over time.

Budget Period

Budget periods are usually 12 months long. The Notice of Award will show the approved budget for the applicable budget period.

Community-Defined Practice (CDP)

A practice that has yielded positive results as determined by community consensus over time. The practice may or may not have been measured empirically but have reached a level of acceptance by the community.

Consortium Agreement

Consortium agreements are between entities working collaboratively on an award-supported project. They address the roles, responsibilities, implementation, and rights and responsibilities between entities collaborating on an award.

Consultant

Consultants are individuals retained to provide professional advice or services for a fee.

Contract

A legal instrument by which a non-federal entity purchases property or services needed to carry out the project or program under a federal award.

Cooperative Agreement

An alternative assistance instrument to be used in lieu of a grant whenever substantial federal involvement with the non-federal entity during performance is anticipated. The difference between grants and cooperative agreements is the degree of federal programmatic involvement rather than the type of administrative requirements imposed.

Direct Cost

Any cost that can be specifically identified with a particular project, program, or activity or that can be directly assigned to such activities relatively easily and with a high degree of accuracy. Direct costs include, but are not limited to, salaries, travel, equipment, and supplies directly benefitting the grant-supported project or activity.

E-Business Point of Contact (EBiz POC)

In Grants.gov, a user registered as an organization applicant who is responsible for the administration and management of grant activities for his or her organization. The EBiz POC is likely to be an organization's chief financial officer or authorizing official. There can be only one EBiz POC per Unique Entity Identifier number.

Evidence-Informed Practice

Evidence-informed practice involves incorporating various forms of evidence, including contextual factors, research, professional expertise, and client preferences and values, to provide effective treatment.

Grant Agreement

A grant agreement is used to enter into a relationship, the principal purpose of which is to transfer anything of value from the federal awarding agency to the non-federal entity to carry out a public purpose authorized by federal statute. It is distinguished from a cooperative agreement in that it does not provide for substantial involvement between the federal awarding agency and the non-federal entity in carrying out the activity.

Indirect Costs

Costs incurred for common or joint objectives that, therefore, cannot be readily identified with an individual project, program, or organizational activity. These costs generally include facilities operation and maintenance costs, depreciation, and administrative expenses. Organizations must have or negotiate an indirect cost rate to support a request for reimbursement of indirect costs.

Local Government

Any unit of government within a state, including a: (a) county; (b) borough; (c) municipality; (d) city; (e) town; (f) township; (g) parish; (h) local public authority, including any public housing agency under the United States Housing Act of 1937; (i) special district; (j) school district; (k) intrastate district; (l) council of governments, whether or not incorporated as a non-profit corporation under state law; and (m) any other agency or instrumentality of a multi-, regional, or intra-state or local government.

Matching or Cost Sharing

The terms "matching" and "cost sharing" are often used interchangeably. Matching usually refers to a statutorily specified percentage, whether specified as a fixed or minimum percentage of non-federal participation in allowable project costs, which must be contributed by a grant recipient to be eligible for federal funding. Cost sharing refers to any situation in which the grant shares in the costs of a project other than as statutorily required matching.

Marketing Partner Identification Number (MPIN)

The MPIN is the access code/password that must be used by the EBiz POC to log into SAM.

Necessary Cost

A cost is necessary if it is vital for the operations of the grant program.

Non-Federal Entity

A state, local government, Indian tribe, institution of higher education, or non-profit organization that carries out a federal award as a recipient or sub-recipient.

Non-Profit Organization

Any corporation, trust, association, cooperative, or other organization, not including institutes of higher education, that: (a) is operated primarily for scientific, educational, service, charitable, or similar purposes in the public interest; (b) is not organized primarily for profit; and (c) uses net proceeds to maintain, improve, or expand the operations of the organization.

Notice of Award (NoA)

The NoA is the official, legally binding document, signed by the Grants Management Officer. It notifies the grant recipient of the award of a grant; includes or references the terms and conditions of the grant and federal funding limits and obligations; and provides the documentary basis for recording the financial and programmatic obligations.

Project Period

The project period is the total time SAMHSA has programmatically approved a project for federal support. This does not constitute a commitment by the Federal Government to fund the entire project period. Each budget period within a project period is subject to the availability of funds and satisfactory progress of the project.

Reasonable Costs

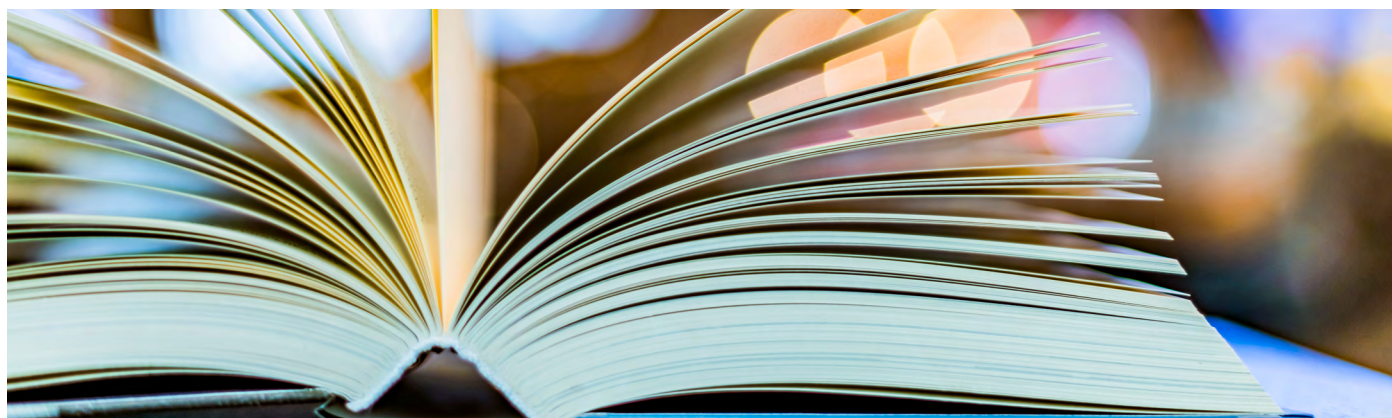
A cost is reasonable if it does not exceed what a prudent person would incur under similar circumstances.

Sub-Recipient

A non-federal entity that receives a sub-award from a pass-through entity to carry out part of a federal program; but does not include an individual that is a beneficiary of such program. A sub-recipient may also be a recipient of other federal awards directly from a federal awarding agency.

Third-Party In-Kind Contributions

Third-party in-kind contributions means the value of non-cash contributions (i.e., property or services) that: (a) benefit a federally assisted project or program; and (b) are contributed by non-federal third parties, without charge, to a non-federal entity under a federal award.



Appendix B: Sample Timeline and Tips for Developing Your Timeline

The sample timeline below shows how you might develop a timeline for your grant project. This example is not the only format you may use to develop your timeline, but it may give you an idea for how you might display the information that must be included in the timeline.

Note that only a few sample activities have been included in the sample timeline. **The key activities listed in the timeline should include all the required activities outlined in the NOFO.**

The format used in the sample timeline allows you to clearly show which activities will take place in each month of the first year of the project. The first year is the time period when the most detail needs to be provided.

Figure 1

Year 1 (in Months)													Year 2		Year 3		Year 4	
Key Activity & Responsible Staff	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13-18 mo	19-24 mo	25-30 mo	31-36 mo	37-42 mo	43-48 mo
START-UP																		
Recruit new staff (PD)	X																	
Hire staff (PD)		X																
Organize Steering Committee (PD)	X																	
Finalize MOUs with partner organizations (PD)			X															
Train staff on EBPs (PC)			X						X				X					
Develop policies and procedures (PD)		X																
IMPLEMENTATION																		
Conduct community outreach (PC)		X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X		
Screen referrals and conduct psychosocial assessments (PC)				X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
EVALUATION/REPORTS																		
Develop data collection plan (E)		X	X															
Collect project data (DM)				X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
Complete Annual Project Performance Report (PD)												X		X		X		X

Key: PD – Project Director, PC – Project Coordinator, SC – Steering Committee, E – Evaluator, DM – Data Manager



Tips to Consider

- Include the position title of the person who will oversee the completion of the activity, not just the person's name.
- If you use abbreviations for responsible staff, such as PD for Project Director, include a key that explains the abbreviations.
- Make a list of all the required activities outlined in the NOFO and include them in your timeline. Don't forget to include the submission of required reports.
- Document the full timeframe that the activities will span. Some activities may span several months. Other activities, such as staff training, may need to be repeated periodically.
- Keep the timeline simple. A complex timeline can make it difficult for reviewers to clearly understand when the activities will be implemented.
- Include activities related to data collection and performance measurement in your timeline.

Weaknesses Often Cited by Reviewers

- Not breaking the timeline into specific enough time frames. Most NOFOs require service delivery to start by the fourth month of the project. Many applicants include a table similar to Figure 1, but the timeline is broken down into quarters for each of the years. If the table indicates that service delivery will begin in the second quarter, it is not possible to determine if service delivery will begin in month 4 or not until month 6.
- Not including a timeline that covers all the years of the project period
- Using a font for the timeline that is smaller than what is permitted
- Including the name of an organization or "All" rather than including the position titles for responsible staff
- Developing a timeline that is not realistic, particularly not allowing for sufficient time to recruit, hire, and train staff before you will implement services. This issue is most evident when many of the project staff members must be hired.

Appendix C: Memorandum of Understanding and Letter of Commitment Sample Templates

Memorandum of Understanding Sample Template

A Memorandum of Understanding (MOU) is an agreement between two or more parties to collaborate on a project. It is a non-binding document that outlines the general terms and understanding of the collaborative relationship.

A sample template for an MOU is provided on the following page.

MEMORANDUM OF UNDERSTANDING
BETWEEN
NON-PROFIT AGENCY AND
COMMUNITY-BASED ORGANIZATION

This Memorandum of Understanding (MOU), while not a legally binding document, does indicate a voluntary agreement to assist in the implementation of the plans described in the “Title of Project,” a substance use/misuse prevention demonstration grant targeting high-risk female adolescent populations. This grant is funded through the Department of Health and Human Services, Substance Abuse and Mental Health Services Administration, Center for Substance Abuse Prevention and is expected to have a 3-year funding cycle.

Overall Project Goals, Services and Outcomes: very brief program overview

Term One: *This MOU shall begin upon grant funding approval. The agreement is renewable from year to year, unless either party gives notice of intent to withdraw from the project.*

Term Two: *Agency Provisions: In addition to continuing the ongoing program planning and review process of “Title of Project,” the non-profit organization will provide the following services in specific support of this project:*

- | | |
|----|----|
| a. | c. |
| b. | d. |

Term Three: *Agency Provisions: In addition to participating in the ongoing planning and review process of the above-mentioned project, the community-based organization will provide the following services in specific support of this project:*

- | | |
|----|----|
| a. | c. |
| b. | d. |

Term Four: *Termination: This MOU may be terminated by either party, for any reason, by giving 30 days written notice.*

Non-Profit Agency Signature

CBO Agency Signature

Title

Title

Date

Date

Letter of Commitment Sample Template

A Letter of Commitment is a letter that outlines the involvement of a partner in a project and identifies the specific contributions they will make to ensure the project's success. A Letter of Commitment should include the following four items:

- How long and in what capacity the organization has been working with your organization
- The specific responsibilities the organization will assume during the proposed grant award period for the project
- Why the organization supports the project
- How the project betters the community/clients

A Letter of Commitment is different from a Letter of Support. A Letter of Support describes general support of the grant project, while a Letter of Commitment outlines the specific contributions an organization will make in the project. SAMHSA's NOFOs specify that Letters of Support should not be included in the application.

A sample template for a Letter of Commitment is provided on the following page.

On Letterhead of Partnering Organization

Insert date

Project Director

Applicant Organization

City, State Zip

Dear *Project Director*,

[Optional short introduction of the partnering organization]. Include information about how long and in what capacity the partnering organization has worked with the applicant organization.

We commit to participating in and supporting the 2025 application to SAMHSA entitled *Project Title*, for the time period of *[include dates of commitment within proposed project period]*.

We will provide the following services for the proposed project:

Describe how the partnering organization will commit to being involved in the project, including its roles and responsibilities.

The individuals and our organization agree to work collaboratively with *Name of Applicant Organization* to ensure our goals are in alignment with the goals of the proposed project, including efforts to track and report on outcomes. We believe that the proposed project will contribute to *how the proposed project will positively impact the state/community/clients*.

Sincerely,

Signature of Authorized Representative (AR)

Name of AR

AR's Title (e.g., Executive Director)

Address and telephone number if that information is not on the letterhead

Appendix D: Sample Work Plan

The sample work plan below shows how you might organize the tasks you need to complete as part of the application process, assign responsibility for completing each task, and ensure you complete the tasks in time to submit your application 2 or 3 days before the deadline.

Figure 2

Name of Grant:	Drug Court			
Grant Release Date:	January 2, 2025			
Grant Due Date:	March 2, 2025			

Proposal Component	Person(s) Responsible	Draft Due Date	Final Due Date	Complete (✓)
Registrations				
SAM Registration				
Grants.gov Registration				
eRA Commons Registration				
Project Narrative/Abstract				
Statement of Need				
Implementation Plan				
Evidence-Based Practices				
Staff and Organizational Experience				
Data Collection/Performance Assessment				
Abstract				
Budget				
Budget Narrative				
Narrative Justification				
SF-424/SF-424A				

Proposal Component	Person(s) Responsible	Draft Due Date	Final Due Date	Complete (✓)
Attachments/Required Forms				
Participant Protection				
Letters of Commitment/MOUs				
Data Collection Instruments				
Staff Qualifications				
Job Descriptions				
Consent Forms				
Copy of Letter to State Point of Contact				
Charitable Choice Form				
Documentation of Non-Profit Status				
Negotiated Indirect Cost Rate Agreement (if applicable)				
FINAL REVIEW				
Submit to Grants.gov			February 28, 2025	

Appendix E: Presenting Demographic Data

It is not necessary to present demographic data in a table, but this format may help you clearly outline the information for reviewers. Two samples are presented below.

Some NOFOs require applicants to compare the demographic characteristics of the population of focus with the population in the larger geographic area, which may be a county or a state. Figure 3 provides an example of how this information might be displayed.

Figure 3: Demographics

Demographic Subgroup	Population of Focus (Number/percentage)	County	State
Male			
Female			
Lesbian, Gay, Bisexual			
White			
African American			
Hispanic/Latino			
Asian			
American Indian/Alaska Native (AI/AN)			
Native Hawaiian/Pacific Islander			
Other			
Non-English Speaking			
Unemployed (age 16+)			
0-18 years			
Over 18			
High School Diploma (age 25+)			
Bachelor's Degree (age 25+)			
Below Poverty Level			
Uninsured			
On Medicaid			
Median Household Income			

Figure 4 highlights all the demographic information that you may be required to submit. A common weakness that reviewers often identify is that applicants do not provide information on all the required elements outlined in Section A of the Project Narrative. Including all the required components in a table will allow you to clearly document this information for reviewers and help ensure that you have addressed all the elements.

Figure 4

	County 1 Number/percentage	County 2	County 3
Race/Ethnicity			
White			
African American			
Hispanic/Latino			
Asian			
AI/AN			
Native Hawaiian/Pacific Islander			
Other			
Federally Recognized Tribe(s)			
Name of Tribe(s)			
Language			
Non-English Speaking			
Sex			
Male			
Female			
Sexual Orientation			
Lesbian, Gay, Bisexual			
Age			
0–18			
18–64			
Over 65			
Socioeconomic Status			
High School Diploma (age 25+)			
Bachelor’s Degree (age 25+)			
Below Poverty Level			
Uninsured			
On Medicaid			
Median Household Income			

Points to Keep in Mind

- Thoroughly discuss the information in the table, particularly demographic information that is noteworthy and directly ties to the focus of the NOFO. For example, if your table shows that there is a relatively high percentage of the population of focus that reside in non-English speaking families, it would be important to note this in the Implementation Approach section of your Project Narrative and explain how you will address this factor in your project.
- The data on age will depend on the age group that is the focus of the NOFO. For example, if the NOFO focuses on the provision of services to children, it would be important to provide a breakdown of age ranges below age 18.
- Additional categories may be needed, depending on the focus of the NOFO, such as percentage of homeless individuals or veterans.
- Explain what languages other than English are spoken in the geographic catchment area.



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Appendix F: Sample Template for Displaying Personnel Information

It is not necessary to display information about project staff in a table, but this format may help you clearly outline the information for reviewers and help ensure that you have addressed all the required elements.

Figure 5

Key Personnel and Other Significant Project Staff	Level of Effort	Role	Qualifications
Project Director – Dr. Jane Smith	.75 FTE	- Project oversight - Manage relationships with project partners - Lead trainer and supervisor - Functions in a leadership role on the Advisory Board - Oversees the Quality Improvement team	- Ph.D. in Psychology 20 years of clinical experience, including 15 years of managing programs in children’s mental health - Expertise in working with at-risk populations, bilingual (Spanish)
Clinical Coordinator (to be hired)	1.0 FTE	- Oversee implementation of clinical services - Supervise counselors and case managers - Assist with completing required reports	- Licensed Clinician (minimum – Master’s Level) 15 years of clinical experience working with children and/or families to include experience providing clinical supervision and provision of training on EBP’s
Evaluator – Dr. Elaine Miller	.6 FTE	- Oversee data analysis/ performance assessment - Serves as a member of the Quality Improvement team - Prepares required reports	- Ph.D. in Public Health - Evaluator on 3 SAMHSA grants - Faculty, University Health Research Institute for 15 years with emphasis on mental health program evaluation

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Appendix G: Data Resources

Data Resources for the Statement of Need

U.S. Census Bureau American Community Survey	www.census.gov/programs-surveys/acs
Bureau of Justice Statistics	https://bjs.ojp.gov
County Health Rankings	www.countyhealthrankings.org
Health Data and Profiles for State, Tribal, Local, and Territorial Public Health Professionals Gateway	www.cdc.gov/public-health-gateway/php/index.html
Healthy People 2030	https://odphp.health.gov/healthypeople
Health Resources and Services Administration (HRSA) Health Professional Shortage Areas	https://data.hrsa.gov/tools/shortage-area
National Center for Education Statistics	https://nces.ed.gov
National Center for Health Statistics	https://cdc.gov/nchs
National Center for HIV/AIDS, Viral Hepatitis, STD, and TB Prevention (NCHHSTP) AtlasPlus	www.cdc.gov/nchhstp/about/atlasplus.html?CDC_AAref_Val=https://www.cdc.gov/nchhstp/atlas/
National Institute on Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism	www.niaaa.nih.gov
National Institute on Drug Abuse	https://nida.nih.gov
National Library of Medicine	https://www.nlm.nih.gov

National Vital Statistics System	https://www.cdc.gov/nchs/nvss/index.htm
Office of Disease Prevention and Health Promotion	https://odphp.health.gov
SAMHSA Center for Behavioral Health Statistics and Quality Data	www.samhsa.gov/data
The Annie E. Casey Foundation KIDS COUNT Data Center	https://datacenter.aecf.org
U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics	www.bls.gov
U.S. Census Bureau	https://www.census.gov



Appendix H: Additional Resources

System of Award Management (SAM)

www.SAM.gov

Grants.gov

www.grants.gov

eRA Commons Registration

www.era.nih.gov/register-accounts/register-in-era-commons.htm

eRA Help Desk

www.era.nih.gov/need-help

How to Apply for a SAMHSA Grant

www.samhsa.gov/grants/how-to-apply

SAMHSA Notice of Funding Opportunity Application Guide

www.samhsa.gov/grants/how-to-apply/nofo-application-guide

Formatting Requirements

www.samhsa.gov/grants/how-to-apply/forms-and-resources/formatting-requirements-system-validation

Goals and Measurable Objectives

www.samhsa.gov/grants/how-to-apply/forms-and-resources/developing-goals-measurable-objectives

Data Collection and Performance Measurement

www.samhsa.gov/grants/how-to-apply/forms-and-resources/developing-plan-data-collection-performance-measurement

Biographical Sketches and Position Descriptions

www.samhsa.gov/grants/how-to-apply/forms-and-resources/biographical-sketches-position-descriptions

Evidence-Based Practices Resource Center

www.samhsa.gov/resource-search/ebp

SAMHSA Data

www.samhsa.gov/data

Grants Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

www.samhsa.gov/grants/faqs



Substance Abuse and Mental Health
Services Administration

SAMHSA's mission is to lead public health and service delivery efforts that promote mental health, prevent substance misuse, and provide treatments and supports to foster recovery while ensuring access and better outcomes for all.

1-877-SAMHSA-7 (1-877-726-4727) · 1-800-487-4889 (TDD) · www.samhsa.gov